

- 2 Composition** The composition briefs based on the above Topics will make compositional demands in terms of the treatment of ideas, techniques and structures but will be sufficiently open-ended to allow students the freedom to work in any style or genre. Work may use forms and styles associated with western tonal harmony, other techniques of 20th and 21st century art music, popular music and jazz, world music, the media and the stage, and the various modern applications of technology.

The composition will be marked out of 40 against the assessment criteria in *Section 5.6*.

5.5 How the assessment criteria will be applied

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| 1 How the work will be assessed | The assessment criteria in <i>Sections 5.6</i> and <i>5.7</i> are provided for information only and will be applied by an external examiner to assess the submitted work. |
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| 2 Assessing the composition and technical study | For each composition and technical study, examiners will use the holistic assessment criterion (out of 40) to give an overall reflection of the work and use the five detailed assessment criteria (each out of eight) to report on specific aspects of technique and expression. They will then reconcile the totals arrived at by these different routes. |

3 Compulsory and optional assessment criteria for Composition

The five detailed assessment criteria will consist of **three** compulsory plus **two** optional criteria.

Compulsory assessment criteria:

1. Quality of ideas and outcome
2. Coherence
3. Forces and textures.

Optional assessment criteria (two are selected from the following three):

4. Harmony
5. Melody
6. Rhythm.

The examiner will choose the optional assessment criteria that work to the students best advantage.

4 Assessment criteria for technical study

Five detailed assessment criteria will be applied:

Baroque counterpoint

1. Chords and keys (Topics 1, 2 (first part) and 3)
2. Chords and keys (Topic 2, second part)
3. Realisation and additional figuring and chord symbols
4. Sense of line
5. Part writing
6. Style.

Chorale

1. Chords and keys (first part)
2. Chords and keys (second part)
4. Sense of line
5. Part writing
6. Style.

Popular song

1. Chords and keys
3. Realisation and additional figuring and chord symbols
4. Sense of line